

Prionailurus viverrinus, Fishing Cat

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Taxonomy

Kingdom	Phylum	Class	Order	Family
Animalia	Chordata	Mammalia	Carnivora	Felidae

Scientific Name: *Prionailurus viverrinus* (Bennett, 1833)

Synonym(s):

- *Felis viverrina* Bennett, 1833

Common Name(s):

- English: Fishing Cat
- Bengali: Baghrol
- Central Khmer: Kla trey
- Nepali: Malaha biralo
- Sinhala; Sinhalese: Hadun diviya
- Thai: เลือดปลา
- Urdu: Machhli khore billi

Taxonomic Notes:

The Fishing Cat is placed in *Prionailurus* according to genetic analysis (Johnson *et al.* 2006, O'Brien and Johnson 2007, Kitchener *et al.* 2017).

Assessment Information

Red List Category & Criteria: Vulnerable A2cd+3cd+4cd [ver 3.1](#)

Year Published: 2025

Date Assessed: May 16, 2024

Justification:

The Fishing Cat is widely distributed from southern Pakistan, northern India, southern Nepal and Bangladesh to Myanmar, southern Thailand and western Cambodia. However, its distribution is discontinuous as indicated by large gaps between known population units in the lower reaches of the Indus River and the Indian and Nepal Terai region, and between coastal areas along the Bay of Bengal and the Gulf of Thailand. No land corridor exists between continental and Sri Lankan populations. In all range countries, the Fishing Cat largely inhabits wetlands, riverine and mangrove forests, marshes, swamps and grasslands in the vicinity of waterbodies. Current human-dominated landscapes once featured these habitat types but are now fragmented due to severe land use changes in favour of aquaculture, agriculture, infrastructure and industrialisation since at least the late 1980s.

Habitat loss and fragmentation of the Fishing Cat's preferred habitat is aggravated by water pollution in aquaculture sites due to the use of chemicals and sewage reaching surrounding areas untreated. Killing of Fishing Cats is most pronounced in the Ganges Brahmaputra delta and northeastern Bangladesh, mostly in retaliation for perceived loss of small livestock and fish-stock. Linear infrastructure bisecting natural habitats has been entailing roadkills and mortally wounded Fishing Cats, especially in India and

Sri Lanka. Several cases of Fishing Cat meat and body parts being consumed by ethnic groups have been reported in India, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Thailand and Cambodia. There is also some evidence of Fishing Cats being caught, kept and traded as pets in Pakistan, Bangladesh and Thailand.

The presently known and extrapolated sizes of population units suggest a global population of fewer than 8,000 mature individuals. Since Southeast Asia harbours the smallest population units of all, presently estimated at 200 individuals at most, this population faces a far greater extinction risk than populations in South Asia. We suspect a global population decline of 30% or more in the past three Fishing Cat generations during 2008–2023, as quality and extent of suitable grassland and wetland habitats declined during this period by more than 30% in several regions, where land use and land cover changes have been studied. We consider it highly likely that this decline will continue and accelerate in the future three generations during 2024–2038, concurrent with presumed future trends of severe and extensive habitat conversions and degradations in all range countries, especially in coastal areas. Effective and sustainable interventions are unlikely to be of sufficient magnitude to prevent such decline rates. We therefore categorize the Fishing Cat as Vulnerable under criteria A2cd+3cd+4cd.

Previously Published Red List Assessments

2016 – Vulnerable (VU)

2010 – Endangered (EN)

2008 – Endangered (EN)

2002 – Vulnerable (VU)

1996 – Lower Risk/near threatened (LR/NT)

1994 – Insufficiently Known (K)

Geographic Range

Range Description:

The Fishing Cat is widely but discontinuously distributed in South and Southeast Asia from southern Pakistan in the west to Cambodia in the east, and from the Himalayan foothills of the Terai and the Dooars in the north to Sri Lanka and Thailand in the south. However, currently known occurrence is highly localized with large gaps of more than 100 km between sites with authenticated presence records. Such gaps are most prevalent in the basins of the Indus, Ganges, Brahmaputra, Ayeyarwady and Chao Phraya rivers, and along the coasts of the Bay of Bengal and the Gulf of Thailand. At present, its main range appears to be the Indian and Nepal Terai, and the lower reaches and delta of the Ganges and Brahmaputra in India and Bangladesh. Its range extends along major river basins along the east coast of India and throughout much of Sri Lanka. Its range in Southeast Asia is limited to the southern Ayeyarwady Region of Myanmar, coastal areas of western peninsular Thailand and coastal Cambodia. In Viet Nam and Indonesia, it has not been recorded since the early 2000s.

In most range countries, the Fishing Cat was recorded in new locations since the previous assessment of 2016. The majority of records were obtained during camera trapping surveys targeting the Tiger *Panthera tigris* in protected areas of the Terai, Dooars and Sundarban Mangroves, and the Leopard *Panthera pardus* in both protected and unprotected landscapes in Sri Lanka. Its distribution outside

protected areas is still not well understood, and vast stretches with potentially suitable habitat in many human-dominated landscapes have not been surveyed to date. This paucity of surveys outside protected area networks clouds our understanding of the Fishing Cat's biogeography, and how site-specific factors affect its distribution (Rana *et al.* 2022).

The Fishing Cat occurs at sea level in parts of its range (Das *et al.* 2017, Thaung *et al.* 2018, Naing Lin and Platt 2019) to an elevation of 436 m in the Indian Terai (Guleria *et al.* 2022), which represents the highest reliable elevation record in this region to date. In Sri Lanka, it has been recorded up to 2,277 m in Horton Plains National Park (Anjali Watson and Andrew Kittle, unpublished data).

Please see Supplementary Information for details of distribution by range country.

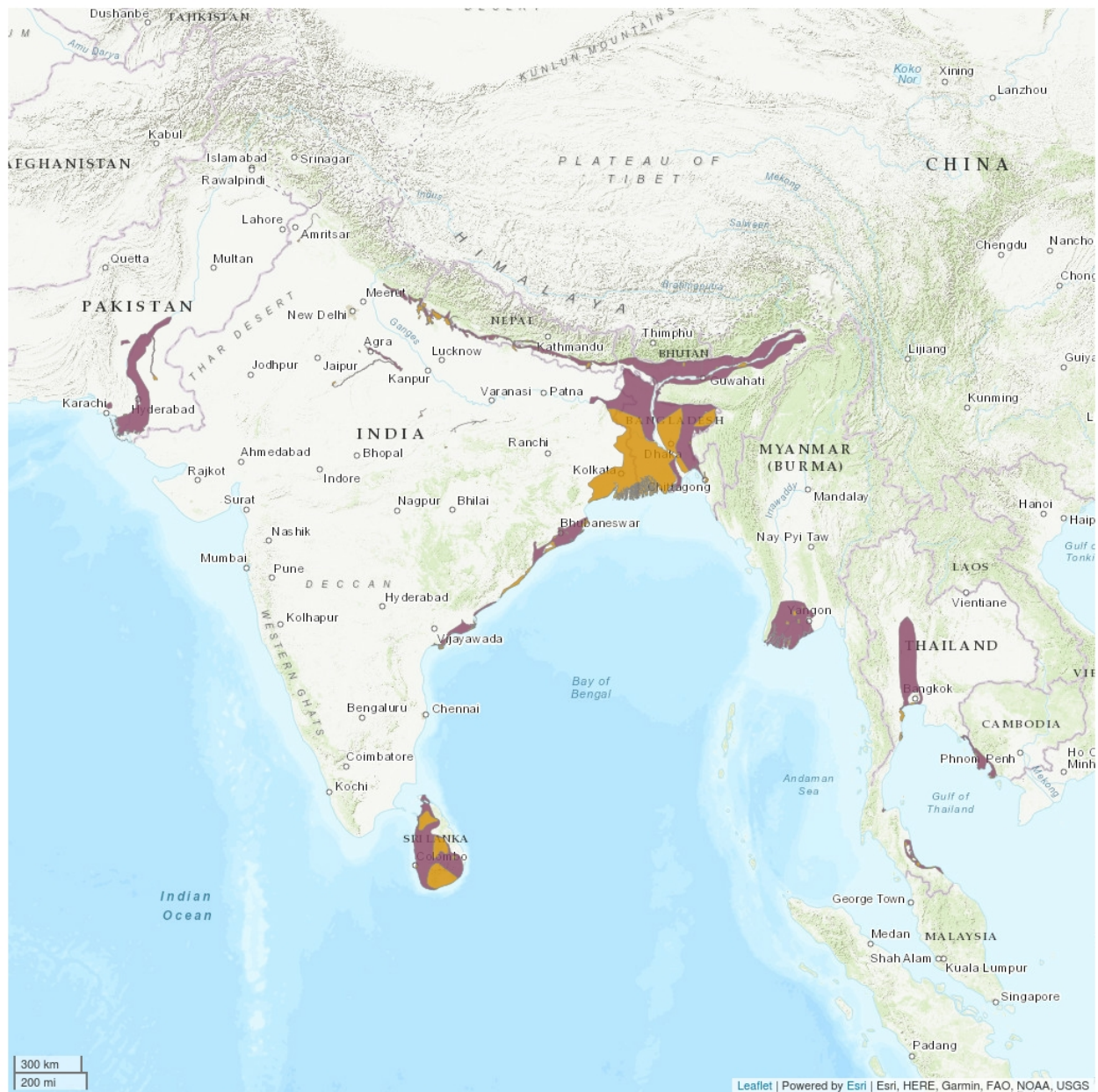
For further information about this species, see [Supplementary Material](#).

Country Occurrence:

Native, Extant (resident): Bangladesh; Cambodia; India; Myanmar; Nepal; Pakistan; Sri Lanka; Thailand

Native, Possibly Extinct: Indonesia (Jawa); Viet Nam

Distribution Map



Legend

- EXTANT (RESIDENT)
- POSSIBLY EXTANT (RESIDENT)

Compiled by:

Mukherjee, S. et al. 2024



The boundaries and names shown and the designations used on this map do not imply any official endorsement, acceptance or opinion by IUCN.

Population

Camera trap surveys indicate that Fishing Cat population density in inland protected areas of the Indian Terai is 3–3.5 individuals/100 km² (Nair 2012). Density is significantly higher in coastal areas, both within and outside protected areas ranging from 18–70 individuals/100 km² (Sathiyaselvam *et al.* 2016, Phosri *et al.* 2021, Adhya *et al.* 2024). We therefore extrapolate these values to those inland and coastal areas, respectively, where population density estimates are lacking. In areas with fewer than three records in one Fishing Cat generation, we refrain from estimating population size due to the paucity of surveys and lack of data. These areas are predominantly situated in human-dominated landscapes, where the Fishing Cat's presence has become known through media reports about killed individuals (see e.g. Chowdhury *et al.* 2015, Chakraborty *et al.* 2022). Based on available and extrapolated estimates, we infer a total population size of 3,194–7,527 Fishing Cats. Most of the population resides in South Asia, with an estimated population size of 1,768–5,088 individuals in India and Bangladesh, and 1,392–2,187 individuals in Sri Lanka. Thailand and Cambodia combined retain an estimated population of 131–200 individuals at most. Please see Supplementary Information for details of estimated population densities and sizes in the range countries.

For further information about this species, see [Supplementary Material](#).

Current Population Trend: Decreasing

Habitat and Ecology (see Appendix for additional information)

In the Indus River basin, the Terai and Indian Dooars, camera trap records of the Fishing Cat have been obtained in mosaics of forests and dense grasslands covered by tall *Imperata*, *Phragmites*, *Saccharum* and *Typha* grasses (Nair 2012, Islam *et al.* 2016, Mishra *et al.* 2018, Jhala *et al.* 2020, Jhala *et al.* 2021, Guleria *et al.* 2022). In protected areas, it was also recorded in open riverine forest interspersed with grasses and herbs (Yadav *et al.* 2018), and in grassland patches close to streams, sandbanks, swamps, oxbow lakes and reservoirs (Taylor *et al.* 2016, Mishra *et al.* 2018, Yadav *et al.* 2020, Jhala *et al.* 2021, Jayasekara and Mahaulpatha 2022). In Indian Tiger Reserves, three individuals were recorded in dry deciduous forests at most 6 km away from streams (Sadhu and Reddy 2013, Talegaonkar *et al.* 2018, Dutta *et al.* 2021). Mangrove forests and remnant mangrove patches represent important habitats along coasts of the Bay of Bengal and the Gulf of Thailand (Sathiyaselvam *et al.* 2016, Das *et al.* 2017, Thaung *et al.* 2018, Chutipong *et al.* 2019, Naing and Platt 2019, Rana 2020, Shankar *et al.* 2020, Jhala *et al.* 2020, Jhala *et al.* 2021, Phosri *et al.* 2021). Outside protected areas, it has repeatedly been recorded near active and abandoned fishponds, in rice fields, oil palm and coconut plantations, abandoned unused land, marshland and on river banks (Cutter 2015, Dahal 2016, Taylor *et al.* 2016, Kantimahanti *et al.* 2019, Kolipaka *et al.* 2019, Naing and Platt 2019, Chakraborty *et al.* 2020a, b, Jhala *et al.* 2021, Mishra *et al.* 2021, Phosri *et al.* 2021). In the Indian state of Odisha, its presence in the Chilika Lagoon is higher in *Phragmites* dominated marshland than in more saline areas with sparse vegetation cover (Adhya *et al.* 2023). It has also been sighted in sugarcane fields during harvest seasons (Mishra 2022, Divyashree Rana pers. comm. 6 January 2023) and documented near commercial fish farms adjacent to tourist destination spots in West Bengal and Odisha (Samrat Chakraborty in litt. 21 August 2023, Adhya *et al.* 2024). In Sri Lanka, it also inhabits tea estates and dry rocky slopes in the vicinity of rivers, lakes and reservoirs (Kittle and Watson 2018), wetland environments in Colombo (Ratnayaka *et al.* 2022), both dry and wet zone forest patches, and intermediate savannah-type forests near waterbodies (Anjali Watson and Andrew Kittle, unpublished data).

A genetic study by Rana (2020) using scat samples and microsatellite markers reveals a low diversity and strong genetic structure between Fishing Cat populations in India. This suggests several landscape level barriers due to the patchiness of wetland habitats and fragmentation owing to anthropogenic activities. The Terai population has comparatively high genetic diversity with a metapopulation structure (Rana 2020).

The home ranges of three radio-collared female Fishing Cats in Chitwan National Park were estimated at 4–6 km², and that of a male at 16–22 km² (Sunquist and Sunquist 2002). The home range of a male individual in Kishanpur Wildlife Sanctuary was estimated at 18.46 km² (Nair 2012). In and around Khao Sam Roi Yot National Park, four females had home ranges of 2.3–5.3 km² in the dry season and of 3.0–4.4 km² in the wet season; the home range of a male varied from 8.9 km² in the dry season to 12.6 km² in the wet season (Cutter 2015). Camera trap records in the same study area indicate that female Fishing Cats moved 598–1,335 m, whereas males moved 1,373–2,285 m per day (Phosri *et al.* 2021). Home ranges of one male and two female Fishing Cats in the same area was estimated at 2.21–4.33 km² and 3.44–8.49 km², respectively, in the wet season of 2022 (Klakhaeng *et al.* 2023). Two females in urban areas of Colombo had home ranges of 3.06–3.39 km², and two males of 32.02–32.99 km² (Ratnayaka *et al.* 2022). Data of 11 radio-collared Fishing Cats in Nepal's Koshi Tappu Wildlife Reserve indicate that males move in an area of about 18–58.4 km² and females in 1.2–34.7 km² both inside and outside the reserve (Rama Mishra in litt. 26 April 2024).

Information on the reproduction of the Fishing Cat in the wild is limited to a few incidental observations. Mating of Fishing Cats was observed in late February to early March in the Indian Sundarbans (Sanyal and Roy 1985). Gestation period is 63–70 days (Sunquist and Sunquist 2002), and litters consist of one to three kittens (Sanyal and Roy 1985, Datye 1993, Cutter and Cutter 2009, Mishra *et al.* 2021, Divyashree Rana in litt. 21 August 2023). Kittens of less than 15 days old were observed in May and January (Sanyal and Roy 1985, Divyashree Rana in litt. 21 August 2023). Females followed by kittens of several weeks of age were observed in mid-March, early January and April to May (Datye 1993, Cutter and Cutter 2009, Malla *et al.* 2019). In the Bhitarkanika mangroves of Odisha, kittens are sighted in all seasons (Manas K Das, Range Officer, pers. comm. 7 September 2023), and newborn kittens were observed from November to June in the Chilika Lagoon (Tiasa Adhya in litt. 21 December 2023).

The Fishing Cat was thought to be largely nocturnal (Mukherjee 1989, Sunquist and Sunquist 2002, Sathiyaselvam *et al.* 2016). Several camera trap records obtained since 2011 show that it is also active during daylight hours (Nair 2012, Islam *et al.* 2016, Mishra *et al.* 2018, Shankar *et al.* 2020, Yadav *et al.* 2020, Jayasekara and Mahaulpatha 2022, Kantimahanti *et al.* 2022, Anjali Watson and Andrew Kittle, unpublished data).

Faeces collected in Keoladeo National Park showed that Fishing Cats predominantly consumed fish all year round, followed by birds, insects and rodents (Haque and Vijayan 1993). Scat collected in Khao Sam Roi Yot National Park indicates that fish constituted 42% of the diet, followed by mammals and birds 24% each, reptiles 5% and crustaceans 2% (Cutter 2015). Scat collected in the same national park contained remains of 16 species including four fish, three rodent and three bird species; the diet varied slightly between summer, rainy and winter seasons, consisting of fish (46.9–54.5%), rodents (21.8–27.7%), birds (19.1–19.8%), insects (0–2.7%), snakes, crabs, snails and arthropods (Wongson *et al.* 2024). Fishing Cats were also observed hunting an Indian Pond Heron *Ardeola grayii*, a Dog-faced Water Snake *Cerberus rynchops* (Malla *et al.* 2018) and a Checkered Keelback *Fowlea piscator* (Kantimahanti *et*

al. 2022). The first arboreal behaviour of Fishing Cats foraging on nests of colonial waterbirds 8 m above ground in the canopy of a tree was documented in 2022 (Sadik and Akash 2024). Scat collected in the Coringa mangroves contained remains of fish (36.6%), crabs (17.8%), rodents (16.8%), birds (14.8%), reptiles (11.4%), molluscs and insects (Malla *et al.* 2024).

Systems: Terrestrial, Freshwater (=Inland waters)

Use and Trade

Little is known about illegal use and trade of the Fishing Cat. In Pakistan, two captive individuals were confiscated and rescued in Karachi in 2015 (Bhatti 2015, Zubairi and Naidu 2016). Three live Fishing Cat kittens were offered for sale on a market in spring 2024, but it was not possible to figure out the location of this incident in Pakistan or abroad (Javed Mahar in litt. 17 May 2024). A few cases of ritual hunting of Fishing Cats for meat and skin have been reported in southern West Bengal (Mukherjee *et al.* 2012). Tribal people in Andhra Pradesh occasionally hunt Fishing Cats for meat (Kantimahanti *et al.* 2019). Indigenous hunters in Sri Lanka's Central Province and in northeastern Bangladesh allegedly consume Fishing Cat meat and use their body parts for medicinal purposes (Thudugala 2016, Sultana *et al.* 2022). In the period 2016–2021, the Bangladesh Forest Department seized 24 live individuals from illegal trafficking that were destined as pets to India or West Asia (Uddin *et al.* 2023). A few local people in Thailand also admitted capturing Fishing Cats for sale as pets and eating their meat (Cutter 2015, Chutipong *et al.* 2019). In Cambodia, a dead Fishing Cat was recovered at a bushmeat stall near the Tonle Sap wetlands in 2018 (Herranz Muñoz and Vong 2022).

Threats (see Appendix for additional information)

The major threat to the Fishing Cat across range countries appears to be the loss and fragmentation of forests, grasslands, wetlands, marshes and mangrove habitats due to the expansion of aquaculture, agriculture, infrastructure and industrialisation (see details in Supplementary Information). The expansion of commercial aquaculture in particular results in the pollution of the entire food chain due to microplastics and the use of chemicals and sewage reaching surrounding areas untreated (Chatterjee *et al.* 2024, Mitra *et al.* 2024). In most range countries, land use changes are aggravated by further conflict with humans for resources like space and small livestock. Such conflicts entail killing of Fishing Cats in retaliation for perceived livestock loss. With expanding linear infrastructure, roadkills are a potential major threat, especially in India and Sri Lanka.

Poaching is a potential threat to the Fishing Cat in Cambodia (Thaung *et al.* 2018). Indiscriminate snaring of mammals in Cambodia and Viet Nam is a major and ongoing threat with a devastating impact on the region's wildlife (Gray *et al.* 2021).

Please see Supplementary Information for detailed threats by range country.

For further information about this species, see [Supplementary Material](#).

Conservation Actions (see Appendix for additional information)

The Fishing Cat is listed in Appendix II of the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora, requiring permits for international trade (Acharjyo 1998). In Pakistan's Sindh province, the Fishing Cat has been protected since 2020 under the First Schedule of the Sindh Wildlife Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management Act 2020, rendering possession, hunting and

trading of protected species illegal (Umar Farooq 2020). In India, it has been protected since 1972 under the highest protection level Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act (Acharjyo 1998) and in the Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act (2022) (Ministry of Law and Justice 2022). In Nepal, it is not listed as protected under the National Parks and Wildlife Conservation Act, 2029 (1973), but hunting wildlife without a license is prohibited (Nepal Law Commission 2018). In Bangladesh, it has been fully protected since 1973 under the Wild Life Preservation Order and since 2012 under the Wildlife (Conservation and Security) Act, 2012 (Sultana *et al.* 2022). In Myanmar, the Fishing Cat is completely protected under the Conservation of Biodiversity and Protected Areas Law of 2018 (Thu *et al.* 2024). It is strictly protected in Sri Lanka under the Fauna and Flora Protection (Amendment) Act of 2009 (Parliament of the Democratic Socialist Republic of Sri Lanka 2009). In Thailand, it is protected under the Wildlife Preservation and Protection Act of 2019, which prohibits intentional killing (Phosri *et al.* 2021). In Cambodia's Natural Resource and Environmental Code, it is listed as common with minimal penalties for its trade and consumption (Gray *et al.* 2017).

Sri Lanka was the first nation to legally protect all its mangrove forests in 2015 (Veettil *et al.* 2023). Mangrove restoration and plantation projects have been implemented in Pakistan (Gilani *et al.* 2021), India (Kubo *et al.* 2018, Parida and Kumar 2020, Samanta *et al.* 2021, Choubey 2024), Bangladesh (Uddin *et al.* 2022), Sri Lanka (UNCC 2023) and Cambodia (Veettil and Quang 2019). The Fishing Cat also benefits from establishment of wildlife corridors in the Indian Terai and the Central Highlands of Sri Lanka (Jhala *et al.* 2021, Resplendent Ceylon 2021, WWCT 2024).

Local people have been sensitized to issues pertaining to the conservation and protection of the Fishing Cat in and around several survey areas in Sri Lanka, West Bengal, Odisha and Andhra Pradesh in India, in Nepal, Thailand and Cambodia (Thudugala 2016, Kolipaka *et al.* 2019, Malla *et al.* 2019, Mishra *et al.* 2021, Phosri *et al.* 2021, Herranz Muñoz and Vong 2022, Kantimahanti *et al.* 2022, Adhya *et al.* 2024). In India, the Fishing Cat has been declared as the State Animal of West Bengal and as the flagship species of Odisha's Chilika Lagoon; a blueprint designed to safeguard the Fishing Cat across the country provides a coherent scheme for essential district-level conservation actions (Rana *et al.* 2022). Educational material and outreach strategies need to be developed and implemented in human-dominated landscapes with a high conflict density like West Bengal and Bangladesh (Chakraborty *et al.* 2022, Sultana *et al.* 2022).

Credits

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Authority/Authorities: IUCN SSC Cat Specialist Group (wild cats)

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External Resources

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Appendix

Habitats

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Habitat	Season	Suitability	Major Importance?
1. Forest -> 1.5. Forest - Subtropical/Tropical Dry	Resident	Suitable	No
1. Forest -> 1.6. Forest - Subtropical/Tropical Moist Lowland	Resident	Suitable	No
1. Forest -> 1.7. Forest - Subtropical/Tropical Mangrove Vegetation Above High Tide Level	Resident	Suitable	Yes
1. Forest -> 1.8. Forest - Subtropical/Tropical Swamp	Resident	Suitable	No
1. Forest -> 1.9. Forest - Subtropical/Tropical Moist Montane	Resident	Suitable	No
3. Shrubland -> 3.5. Shrubland - Subtropical/Tropical Dry	Resident	Suitable	No
3. Shrubland -> 3.6. Shrubland - Subtropical/Tropical Moist	Resident	Suitable	No
4. Grassland -> 4.6. Grassland - Subtropical/Tropical Seasonally Wet/Flooded	Resident	Suitable	Yes
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.1. Wetlands (inland) - Permanent Rivers/Streams/Creeks (includes waterfalls)	Resident	Suitable	Yes
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.3. Wetlands (inland) - Shrub Dominated Wetlands	Resident	Suitable	Yes
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.4. Wetlands (inland) - Bogs, Marshes, Swamps, Fens, Peatlands	Resident	Suitable	Yes
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.5. Wetlands (inland) - Permanent Freshwater Lakes (over 8ha)	Resident	Suitable	Yes
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.6. Wetlands (inland) - Seasonal/Intermittent Freshwater Lakes (over 8ha)	Resident	Suitable	Yes
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.7. Wetlands (inland) - Permanent Freshwater Marshes/Pools (under 8ha)	Resident	Suitable	Yes
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.13. Wetlands (inland) - Permanent Inland Deltas	Resident	Suitable	Yes
14. Artificial/Terrestrial -> 14.1. Artificial/Terrestrial - Arable Land	Resident	Suitable	No
14. Artificial/Terrestrial -> 14.2. Artificial/Terrestrial - Pastureland	Resident	Suitable	No
14. Artificial/Terrestrial -> 14.4. Artificial/Terrestrial - Rural Gardens	Resident	Suitable	No
14. Artificial/Terrestrial -> 14.5. Artificial/Terrestrial - Urban Areas	Resident	Marginal	-
15. Artificial/Aquatic & Marine -> 15.1. Artificial/Aquatic - Water Storage Areas (over 8ha)	Resident	Suitable	Yes
15. Artificial/Aquatic & Marine -> 15.2. Artificial/Aquatic - Ponds (below 8ha)	Resident	Suitable	Yes

Habitat	Season	Suitability	Major Importance?
15. Artificial/Aquatic & Marine -> 15.3. Artificial/Aquatic - Aquaculture Ponds	Resident	Suitable	Yes
15. Artificial/Aquatic & Marine -> 15.7. Artificial/Aquatic - Irrigated Land (includes irrigation channels)	Resident	Suitable	Yes
15. Artificial/Aquatic & Marine -> 15.8. Artificial/Aquatic - Seasonally Flooded Agricultural Land	Resident	Suitable	Yes
15. Artificial/Aquatic & Marine -> 15.9. Artificial/Aquatic - Canals and Drainage Channels, Ditches	Resident	Suitable	Yes

Use and Trade

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

End Use	Local	National	International
1. Food - human	Yes	No	No
13. Pets/display animals, horticulture	No	Yes	No

Threats

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Threat	Timing	Scope	Severity
1. Residential & commercial development -> 1.1. Housing & urban areas	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Rapid declines
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality	
1. Residential & commercial development -> 1.2. Commercial & industrial areas	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Rapid declines
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
1. Residential & commercial development -> 1.3. Tourism & recreation areas	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Slow, significant declines
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
2. Agriculture & aquaculture -> 2.1. Annual & perennial non-timber crops -> 2.1.2. Small-holder farming	Ongoing	Unknown	Slow, significant declines
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
2. Agriculture & aquaculture -> 2.1. Annual & perennial non-timber crops -> 2.1.3. Agro-industry farming	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Rapid declines
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance 2. Species Stresses -> 2.3. Indirect species effects -> 2.3.7. Reduced reproductive success	

2. Agriculture & aquaculture -> 2.3. Livestock farming & ranching -> 2.3.2. Small-holder grazing, ranching or farming	Unknown	Unknown	Negligible declines
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance		
2. Agriculture & aquaculture -> 2.3. Livestock farming & ranching -> 2.3.3. Agro-industry grazing, ranching or farming	Ongoing	Unknown	Unknown
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance		
2. Agriculture & aquaculture -> 2.4. Marine & freshwater aquaculture -> 2.4.1. Subsistence/artisinal aquaculture	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Unknown
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality		
2. Agriculture & aquaculture -> 2.4. Marine & freshwater aquaculture -> 2.4.2. Industrial aquaculture	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Causing/could cause fluctuations
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance		
2. Agriculture & aquaculture -> 2.4. Marine & freshwater aquaculture -> 2.4.3. Scale Unknown/Unrecorded	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Rapid declines
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance		
3. Energy production & mining -> 3.2. Mining & quarrying	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Unknown
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance		
4. Transportation & service corridors -> 4.1. Roads & railroads	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Rapid declines
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality		
5. Biological resource use -> 5.1. Hunting & trapping terrestrial animals -> 5.1.1. Intentional use (species is the target)	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Rapid declines
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.3. Indirect ecosystem effects 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality		
5. Biological resource use -> 5.1. Hunting & trapping terrestrial animals -> 5.1.2. Unintentional effects (species is not the target)	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Causing/could cause fluctuations
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.3. Indirect ecosystem effects 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality		
5. Biological resource use -> 5.1. Hunting & trapping terrestrial animals -> 5.1.3. Persecution/control	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Rapid declines
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.3. Indirect ecosystem effects 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality		
5. Biological resource use -> 5.4. Fishing & harvesting aquatic resources -> 5.4.3. Unintentional effects: (subsistence/small scale) [harvest]	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Slow, significant declines
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.3. Indirect ecosystem effects 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality		
6. Human intrusions & disturbance -> 6.1. Recreational activities	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Slow, significant declines
Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion		

2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance			
7. Natural system modifications -> 7.2. Dams & water management/use -> 7.2.1. Abstraction of surface water (domestic use)	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
7. Natural system modifications -> 7.2. Dams & water management/use -> 7.2.2. Abstraction of surface water (commercial use)	Ongoing	-	-
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
7. Natural system modifications -> 7.2. Dams & water management/use -> 7.2.3. Abstraction of surface water (agricultural use)	Ongoing	-	-
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
7. Natural system modifications -> 7.2. Dams & water management/use -> 7.2.4. Abstraction of surface water (unknown use)	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
7. Natural system modifications -> 7.2. Dams & water management/use -> 7.2.7. Abstraction of ground water (agricultural use)	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
7. Natural system modifications -> 7.2. Dams & water management/use -> 7.2.9. Small dams	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
7. Natural system modifications -> 7.2. Dams & water management/use -> 7.2.10. Large dams	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
7. Natural system modifications -> 7.2. Dams & water management/use -> 7.2.11. Dams (size unknown)	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
8. Invasive and other problematic species, genes & diseases -> 8.1. Invasive non-native/alien species/diseases -> 8.1.1. Unspecified species	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.3. Indirect species effects -> 2.3.2. Competition	
9. Pollution -> 9.1. Domestic & urban waste water -> 9.1.1. Sewage	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance	
9. Pollution -> 9.1. Domestic & urban waste water -> 9.1.2. Run-off	Ongoing	Minority (<50%)	Causing/could cause fluctuations

	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance
9. Pollution -> 9.1. Domestic & urban waste water -> 9.1.3. Type Unknown/Unrecorded	Ongoing	Minority (<50%) Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance
9. Pollution -> 9.2. Industrial & military effluents -> 9.2.3. Type Unknown/Unrecorded	Ongoing	Unknown Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance
9. Pollution -> 9.3. Agricultural & forestry effluents -> 9.3.1. Nutrient loads	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%) Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance
9. Pollution -> 9.3. Agricultural & forestry effluents -> 9.3.2. Soil erosion, sedimentation	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%) Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance
9. Pollution -> 9.3. Agricultural & forestry effluents -> 9.3.3. Herbicides and pesticides	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%) Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality
9. Pollution -> 9.3. Agricultural & forestry effluents -> 9.3.4. Type Unknown/Unrecorded	Ongoing	Minority (<50%) Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance
9. Pollution -> 9.4. Garbage & solid waste	Ongoing	Whole (>90%) Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance
11. Climate change & severe weather -> 11.1. Habitat shifting & alteration	Ongoing	Minority (<50%) Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality
11. Climate change & severe weather -> 11.4. Storms & flooding	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%) Causing/could cause fluctuations
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.3. Indirect ecosystem effects 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality
12. Other options -> 12.1. Other threat	Ongoing	Minority (<50%) Slow, significant declines
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance

Conservation Actions in Place

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Conservation Action in Place
In-place research and monitoring

Conservation Action in Place
Action Recovery Plan: Yes
Systematic monitoring scheme: No
In-place land/water protection
Conservation sites identified: No
Percentage of population protected by PAs: 41-50
Area based regional management plan: No
Occurs in at least one protected area: Yes
Invasive species control or prevention: No
In-place species management
Harvest management plan: No
Successfully reintroduced or introduced benignly: No
Subject to ex-situ conservation: No
In-place education
Subject to recent education and awareness programmes: Yes
Included in international legislation: Yes
Subject to any international management / trade controls: Yes

Conservation Actions Needed

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Conservation Action Needed	Notes
1. Land/water protection -> 1.1. Site/area protection	-
1. Land/water protection -> 1.2. Resource & habitat protection	-
2. Land/water management -> 2.1. Site/area management	-
2. Land/water management -> 2.3. Habitat & natural process restoration	-
3. Species management -> 3.4. Ex-situ conservation -> 3.4.1. Captive breeding/artificial propagation	-
4. Education & awareness -> 4.2. Training	-
4. Education & awareness -> 4.3. Awareness & communications	-
5. Law & policy -> 5.4. Compliance and enforcement -> 5.4.2. National level	-
5. Law & policy -> 5.4. Compliance and enforcement -> 5.4.3. Sub-national level	-

Research Needed

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Research Needed	Notes
1. Research -> 1.2. Population size, distribution & trends	Conduct surveys in range countries where distribution and status is unclear like Indus basin in Pakistan, Brahmaputra valley in India, Ayeyarwady basin and delta in Myanmar, and coastal areas in the Gulf of Thailand. Initiate surveys in areas identified as potentially suitable habitat. Perform reliable estimates for population density and size both inside and outside protected areas using standardised methods and suitable camera trapping designs. Study areas should be selected in regions and habitats where the fishing cat is known to occur but with currently scarce data. Additionally, surveys should be conducted in areas identified as potentially suitable habitat. Generate information on genetic connectivity of fishing cat population units, including estimates of effective population sizes.
1. Research -> 1.3. Life history & ecology	Generate information on fishing cat diet and monitor prey base. Standardise new techniques using genetic tools.
1. Research -> 1.4. Harvest, use & livelihoods	-

Research Needed	Notes
1. Research -> 1.5. Threats	Identify and prioritise threats. monitor human-induced mortality of fishing cats in range countries and regions, which are known to be killing hotspots like west bengal in india and bangladesh. analyse water quality and potential impact of pollution due to solid waste and chemical contamination on fishing cat health in study sites that are afforded a low to no protection level.
1. Research -> 1.6. Actions	Investigate interconnectivity between habitats suitable for the fishing cat, where wildlife corridors can and need to be established. identify stakeholders engaged in restoration of degraded habitats where the fishing cat occurs and develop joint conservation measures. determine approaches and best practises to mitigate human-induced mortality of fishing cats.
2. Conservation Planning -> 2.1. Species Action/Recovery Plan	National-level action and recovery plans are urgently required.
2. Conservation Planning -> 2.2. Area-based Management Plan	Identify and prioritise key areas for required conservation actions in all fishing cat range countries. initiate trans-boundary fishing cat conservation units and collaborative population monitoring.

Research Needed	Notes
3. Monitoring -> 3.1. Population trends	Monitor population trends periodically every five years in areas, where baseline information is available. generate baseline information in areas where information is scarce or not available.
3. Monitoring -> 3.3. Trade trends	Investigate and assess national and international trade of fishing cats.
3. Monitoring -> 3.4. Habitat trends	Monitor land use changes in areas where the fishing cat is known to occur.

Additional Data Fields

Distribution
Estimated area of occupancy (AOO) (km ²): 115000
Continuing decline in area of occupancy (AOO): Yes
Extreme fluctuations in area of occupancy (AOO): No
Estimated extent of occurrence (EOO) (km ²): 238000
Continuing decline in extent of occurrence (EOO): Unknown
Extreme fluctuations in extent of occurrence (EOO): No
Continuing decline in number of locations: Unknown
Extreme fluctuations in the number of locations: No
Lower elevation limit (m): 0
Upper elevation limit (m): 2,277
Population
Continuing decline of mature individuals: Yes
Extreme fluctuations: No
Population severely fragmented: No
Continuing decline in subpopulations: Unknown
Extreme fluctuations in subpopulations: No
All individuals in one subpopulation: No

Habitats and Ecology
Continuing decline in area, extent and/or quality of habitat: Yes
Generation Length (years): 5
Movement patterns: Not a Migrant

The IUCN Red List Partnership



The IUCN Red List of Threatened Species™ is produced and managed by the [IUCN Global Species Programme](#), the [IUCN Species Survival Commission \(SSC\)](#) and [The IUCN Red List Partnership](#).

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